Nikolas Astra

IT Support Specialist | Technical Troubleshooting & Automation
Los Angeles, CA | contact@nikastra.com | nikastra.com | GitHub: astra-media | LinkedIn: in/nikastra

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT Support Specialist with hands-on experience diagnosing and resolving hardware, software and network issues across macOS, Windows and Linux environments. Builds, upgrades and repairs systems and troubleshoots networks down to the component level. Brings a software and hardware development background (Python, C++, C#, full-stack MERN applications with secure authentication and payment integration, and microcontroller-based IoT automation) that enables faster root cause analysis, scripting and automation of routine tasks, and clear communication of complex issues to non-technical users.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Hardware & Peripherals: PC/laptop assembly, upgrades & repair, hardware diagnostics, component-level troubleshooting, workstation setup and configuration
Operating Systems & Software: Windows, macOS, Linux - support, troubleshooting, installation and configuration, Microsoft 365
Networking: Network setup and troubleshooting, TCP/IP, DNS/DHCP, VPN, router and Wi-Fi connectivity, device configuration
Help Desk & User Support: Ticket triage and prioritization, end-user support, remote troubleshooting, password resets and account setup, documentation
Automation & IoT: Python scripting, Arduino/ESP microcontroller, Arduino Cloud, Alexa integration
Web Development: JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Express, HTML/CSS, REST APIs, JWT/bcrypt, Stripe, PayPal, Shopify Liquid
Databases: MongoDB, PostgreSQL
Languages & Tools: Python, C++, C#, Git, npm, Command Line
Design: Fusion 360, Adobe Creative Suite, TouchDesigner
Soft Skills: Technical troubleshooting under pressure, clear communication with non-technical users, cross-functional collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer - Variable Z - Los Angeles, CA *2021 - Present*

- Debug and maintain a live, customer-facing production platform handling real transactions, resolving issues across front-end, back-end, third-party integrations (Stripe, PayPal).
- Diagnose and resolve issues in authentication, order processing, and payment systems, identifying root causes and deploying fixes with minimal disruption.
- Manage releases and deployments, applying structured testing and troubleshooting to maintain platform stability.

Freelance Full-Stack Developer - Remote *2020 - Present*

- Deliver direct technical support to clients - gathering requirements, diagnosing issues, and explaining solutions in plain, non-technical language.
- Coordinate deployments and manage shared codebases using Git-based workflows.
- Resolve ongoing technical and performance issues across multiple client projects.

UI Developer - SeePoint, LLC - Redondo Beach, CA *2019 - 2021*

- Maintained and troubleshot the company e-commerce website, resolving functional issues to keep the site running reliably.
- Developed and supported UI components for kiosk-based hardware systems, working at the intersection of hardware and software.

Computer Lab Technician - Woodbury University - Burbank, CA *2016 - 2018*

- Delivered front-line technical support across Mac and Windows environments in a high-traffic computer lab, resolving hardware, software, and network issues for students and staff.
- Diagnosed and triaged technical problems under time pressure, prioritizing issues to minimize user downtime.
- Maintained lab hardware and systems to ensure consistent uptime and reliability.

Interactive Design Intern - VirtuLabs - San Francisco, CA *2017*

- Contributed to Project SkyLights installation presented at Digital Design Days + OFFF Milano.
- Integrated TouchDesigner with hardware systems for real-time visual experiences.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science
Woodbury University - Burbank, CA